



Authorised Mental Health Practitioner SOP

Scope

Site	Department, division or operational area	Applicable to
Royal Perth Bentley Group (RPBG)	Mental Health (MH) Division All clinical areas	Medical, Nursing, Allied Health, Clinical Psychologists

Purpose

The purpose of this standard operational procedure (SOP) is to ensure that authorised mental health practitioners (AMHPs) adhere to the Office of the Chief Psychiatrist (OCP) legislative requirements and that the MH Division monitors and maintains governance over the requirement to provide AMHPs.

A key role of the AMHP is to assess and refer a patient suspected of having a mental illness for examination by a psychiatrist.

Links to relevant documents

- [Clinicians' Practice Guide to the Mental Health Act 2014](#)
- [Section 540 \(1\) of the Mental Health Act \(MHA\) 2014](#) and [Regulations 17 of the Mental Health Regulations 2015](#)

Procedure details

The RPBG MH Division adheres to the OCP requirements and is required to keep a register of authorised clinicians as per the MHA 2014 and Mental Health Regulations 2015.

The MH Division Medical Co-Director is responsible for the delegation list for approving AMHPs training and authorisation.

MH Division Program Managers and the MH Nursing Coordinators (CoNs), will maintain oversight of the approval of applications for AMHPs within their service, as applicable. The Program Managers and the CoNs will also be the first point of escalation for any gaps in provision and training.

AMHPs qualifications/training & experience requirements

Program Managers and the relevant CoN are to ensure that the Chief Psychiatrist's (CPs) minimum requirements are met, i.e. that relevant staff have the following qualifications, training and experience to perform the functions of an AMHP under the MHA 2014 (s. 539):

- At least 3 years' experience in the management of patients who have a mental illness (s. 538) and

AMHPs qualifications/training & experience requirements cont'd

- Can be any of the following:
 - a) A psychologist registered with the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law (HPRNL) (Western Australia) in the psychology profession
 - b) A nurse whose name is in Division 1 of the Register of Nurses kept under the HPRNL (WA) as a registered nurse
 - c) An occupational therapist registered with the HPRNL (WA) in the OT profession
 - d) A social worker.

Staff who wish to apply are to seek initial approval for nomination from their line manager.

For other competencies/training/supervision expectations refer to the [OCP website](#), Requirements for AMHP Authorisation section below and for further information about the AMHP role see Addendum 8 – Role of Authorised Mental Health Practitioners.¹

List of Authorised MH Practitioners

- An Official Register of AMHPs is available on the [OCP website](#). The CP must keep a register of persons who are or have been, designated under s.539 as AMHPs
- The MH Division Executive Assistant (EA)
 - Registers/maintains a current list of RPBG AMHPs and retains evidence of submitted applications and completion of pre-requisite training (i.e. certificates of training) in a WDrive folder with limited access
 - Forwards the AMHP Nomination Form and a copy of pre-requisite training (with certificates showing completion of prerequisite training) for approval by the Medical Co-Director
 - Forwards approved AMHP Nomination forms/other documentation to the OCP via email amhp@ocp.wa.gov.au
 - Updates the register of approved AMHPs
- Program Managers/CoNs
 - Coordinate the approved AMHP resources/requirements within each service. Any issues arising regarding AMHPs movements, extended leave, professional practice that is subject to investigation and compliance are to be reported directly to the OCP via email amhp@ocp.wa.gov.au including
 - Advise the OCP of changes. Refer to **Resigning/Relinquishing AMHP Role** and **Leave/Other Changes** sections

Requirements for AMHP authorisation/ continuation of AMHP authorisation

- The successful completion of the AMHP training and subsequent approval provided by the CP as published in the Government Gazette Notices
- The completion of at least 5 hours per year of continuing professional development (CPD) specific to the AMHP role and approved by the CP
- Participation in at least 6 clinic supervision sessions a year approved by the CP completed as
 - One-on-one meeting, i.e. face-to-face/using media (MS Teams/other tele or videoconferencing)
 - Peer group supervision: group discussion of key clinical issues

Authorised Mental Health Practitioner SOP

Version: 3

Endorsed by: Clinical Practice Committee 05/05/2022

Authorised by: Culture of Continuous Improvement Committee 10/05/2022

Date Compiled: 06/2018

Document Owner: Coordinator of Nursing, Mental Health

Revision Due: 05/2026

Requirements for AMHP authorisation/ continuation of AMHP authorisation cont'd

- When requested by the CP, provide a record of CPD and clinical supervision on the templates provided on the OCP website
- Attend an OCP AMHP Refresher Course at least every 2 years
- Ensure adherence with the CP requirements and expectations (Regulation 17. Authorised mental health practitioner [Act s.539(4)]).¹

Resigning/relinquishing AMHP role

The AMHP role can be relinquished in the following ways:

- When a clinician:
 - Resigns from the AMHP role/takes extended leave of more than 12 months/ moves to a non-clinical role where AMHP status is not required and is to:
 - Inform their line manager
 - Prior to going on leave/resigning, etc., complete a Request for Revocation Form (OCP website) and E: amhp@ocp.wa.gov.au and/or provide supporting documentation. CP will subsequently publish the revocation in the Government Gazette
 - Consider reauthorisation upon return to position/a clinical role/from leave
- When a line manager:
 - Makes a decision that an AMHP role is no longer required and an AMHP is expected to resign (as per above process)
 - Is aware that:
 - The AMHP's professional practice is subject to investigation is no longer registered, e.g. by the HPRNL/the Australian Health Practitioners Registration Authority or, for social workers, no longer eligible for membership of the Australian Association of Social Workers
 - The AMHP has failed to complete approved annual professional development/annual clinical supervision and is to
 - Complete the appropriate form on the OCP website and E: amhp@ocp.wa.gov.au
- When the CP is aware/informed of any of the above circumstances (e.g. by managers/clinicians) or, additionally, that an AMHP
 - Fails to comply with the CP's self-report survey and the random audit
 - Is experiencing any of the following grounds
 - Mental or physical incapacity
 - Incompetence
 - Neglect of duty or misconduct

Revocation will be advised in writing and published in the Gazette.

Leave/other changes

The AMHP is to inform the CP (E: amhp@ocp.wa.gov.au) of any changes, including

- Taking extended leave of more than 12 months e.g. maternity, etc.
- Name/workplace changes (e.g. moves from one service to another)
 - Complete the relevant form, i.e. Change of Name/Change of Workplace forms and provide evidence that the new workplace supports the continuation of AMHP status (an email with manager included will suffice) and **must** have the approval of the approved delegate (see OCP website for list of delegates)

Clinicians are to:

- Practice within the MHA 2014 and the [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#)
- Complete a Datix Clinical Incident Management System (CIMS), e.g. clinical incident related to provision of AMHPs/Notifiable Incident Reporting to the OCP, if appropriate

RPBG staff to use versions of the Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation (SSCD) that are on Psychiatric Services Online Information System (PSOLIS) or when they become available on PSOLIS. For documents that are not available on PSOLIS, staff must complete the SSCD documents in paper-based or sanctioned writable PDF format. Refer to the **DoH Triage to Discharge Guidelines** for details of which SSCD documents are available on PSOLIS.

Compliance monitoring

The OCP facilitates a regular annual audit of CPD and clinical supervision of all AMHPs.

- Each mental health service is required to support and facilitate supervision of practice and on-going education for all AMPHs operating within the service. For example, the Bentley Health Service provides a minimum of monthly clinical supervision sessions facilitated by a Consultant Psychiatrist to ensure compliance with CP requirements. A register is maintained by OCP of all attendees for each session.
- The MH Division EA will maintain a current list of RPBG AMHPs register to align with the OCP AMHPs register.

Compliance will be monitored as part of the:

- Datix CIMS system process (e.g. clinical incidents relating to authorised AMHPs re: training/care provision)/Notifiable Incident Reporting to the OCP, if appropriate.

Facilitator

Marika Spaseska, Policy and Legislative Compliance Officer, Safety & Quality Unit, MH Division, RPBG

Authors / acknowledgements

We acknowledge the following contributors used to compile this document:

Jill Spears, Coordinator of Mental Health, RPBG; June 2018.

Review authors

David Bruce, Program Manager, Community MH Services, MH Division, RPBG
Michelle De Silva, Coordinator of Mental Health Nursing, MH Division, RPH, RPBG
Jill Spears, Coordinator of Mental Health Nursing, MH Division, RPBG

April 2022 review

Jill Spears, Coordinator of Mental Health Nursing, MH Division, RPBG
Aaron McCartney, A/ Corporate Safety & Quality Manager, Safety & Quality Department, RPBG

MH Division OCP Reauthorisation Implementation Group

- Wade Emmeluth, Service Co-Director; Kirstie Kemble, A/Divisional Safety and Quality Coordinator, Dr David Stevens, Consultant, Clinical lead; Manoh Dumbuya, A/Nurse Unit Manager; Bronwen Larkin, Clinical Systems Support Clerk

Rachael MacLean, Executive Assistant, MH Division, RPBG

References

1. Government of Western Australia. *Chief Psychiatrists Clinicians' Practice Guide to the Mental Health Act 2014*. (2015). Edition 3. Perth, Western Australia.
2. State of Western Australia. (2014). *Western Australia Mental Health Act 2014*. Perth, Western Australia.
3. State of Western Australia. (2020). *Mental Health Regulations 2015*. Perth, Western Australia.

Related policies, practice standards, clinical guidelines

RPBG Policy Hub

- Comprehensive Care Policy
- Adult & Older Adult Community Mental Health Services Triage to Discharge SOP

EMHS Policy Hub

- Clinical Supervision in Mental Health Policy

Department of Health Policy Hub

- Credentialing and Defining Scope of Clinical Practice Policy
- State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation (SSCD)

Other

- [Mental Health Regulations 2015](#)
- [Mental Health Act 2014](#)
- [Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency - Home \(ahpra.gov.au\)](#)
- [Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care](#)
- [Charter of Mental Health Care Principles \(MHA 2014\)](#)

Related National Standards

ACSQHC NSQHS Standards 2nd Edition (2021): Standard 1: Clinical Governance; Standard 6 - Communicating for Safety

NSMHS Standards (2010): Standard 1: Governance for Safety and Quality in Health Service Organisations; Standard 2: Safety; Standard 10: Delivery of Care

Authorised Mental Health Practitioner SOP

Version: 3

Endorsed by: Clinical Practice Committee 05/05/2022

Authorised by: Culture of Continuous Improvement Committee 10/05/2022

Date Compiled: 06/2018

Document Owner: Coordinator of Nursing, Mental Health

Revision Due: 05/2026